

Successor-Saturated Ordinals and Indefinite Tail Activation

A Head-Tail Quantifier Architecture for Cardinal–Ordinal–Indefinite Correlations in a RED/DED Diagnostic Framework

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Abstract

This article develops a stronger lexical architecture for ordinal meaning and its quantificational consequences. Building on the Successor-Closed Sequence Lexicon (SCSL), I treat FIRST as successor-saturated: encoding FIRST lexically guarantees not only an immediate successor ($\text{FIRST} \Rightarrow \text{SECOND}$) but an entire successor tail in the relevant sequence. I introduce Indefinite Tail Activation (ITA) as the interface update that maps this successor tail into a discourse-available remainder, canonically lexicalized as indefiniteness (some, a few, others) and, in certain configurations, as specific-referenced indefinites (all, each, every). The central new hypothesis is an ordinal→remainder-indefinite bridge: the ordinal head (derived from a cardinal index) entails a tail domain of indefinite quantification. I formalize this as a Head–Tail Quantifier Architecture (HTQA) with paired domains: (i) a definite head domain (cardinals and positional quantifiers/ordinals, including determinate and indeterminate ordinal types) and (ii) an indefinite tail domain (specific-referenced vs non-specific-referenced indefinites). The proposal is embedded in a bidirectional RED/DED diagnostic architecture: RED implements refinement along the successor chain ($\text{FIRST} \rightarrow \text{SECOND} \rightarrow \text{THIRD} \rightarrow \dots$), while DED implements controlled collapse and coarsening from refined ordinal microstructure back to a coarse tail expressed by indefinites. The paper is a theory-and-diagnostics contribution: it introduces a new composed lexical mapping (cardinal→ordinal→indefinite tail), derives falsifiable predictions for continuation and cancellation diagnostics, and supplies replication-ready elicitation and coding protocols; it does not report new experimental results. (Panner 2026a; Panner 2026b).

Keywords

ordinals; successor closure; successor saturation; Indefinite Tail Activation; cardinal–ordinal correlation; indefinite quantifiers; generalized quantifiers; presupposition/definedness; discourse update; RED diagnostic; DED collapse; refinement/coarsening; ellipsis/anaphora; crosslinguistic elicitation

Novelty & Contributions (Reviewer-Facing Summary)

1. Lexical architecture: FIRST is a successor-saturating trigger whose definedness presupposes an iterated successor tail (not only SECOND but all successors in the active sequence segment).
2. New composed mapping: a Head–Tail Quantifier Architecture (HTQA) in which the

ordinal head (cardinal-derived) entails a tail domain of indefinites, yielding an ordinal→remainder-indefinite bridge.

3. Indefinite Tail Activation: mentioning FIRST introduces an underspecified remainder discourse resource that is canonically lexicalized as indefiniteness (some/a few/others) and can be shaped by specific-referenced indefinites (all/each/every).
4. RED/DED diagnostics: refinement (RED) and controlled collapse/coarsening (DED) are treated as explicit, measurable procedures that redesign classic implicature diagnostics rather than preserving them.
5. Falsifiability: the paper supplies replication-ready minimal pairs and coding matrices, and states failure conditions that would falsify ITA/HTQA crosslinguistically.

1. Introduction

A position in a sequence is not semantically solitary. If an expression encodes a token as FIRST, the structure that makes FIRST meaningful already encodes successor structure—at minimum a SECOND slot. The Successor-Closed Sequence Lexicon (SCSL) captures this by treating successor availability as a lexical definedness condition for FIRST, yielding $\text{FIRST} \Rightarrow \text{SECOND}$ as a lexical consequence rather than a pragmatic enrichment. This paper strengthens that hypothesis: FIRST is taken to encode not only the next successor, but the entire successor tail, and to introduce that tail into discourse as an underspecified remainder that is canonically lexicalized as indefiniteness. (Beaver 2001).

Box 1. New Hypotheses (H1-H4)

H1 (Successor-saturated lexical entry for FIRST). Encoding an ordinal position as FIRST presupposes a successor-bearing index structure and lexically activates the entire successor tail (not merely SECOND).

H2 (Ordinal-to-indefinite bridge: head entails tail). Interpreting an ordinal head created from cardinal structure entails availability of a tail domain that is canonically realized by indefinite-quantifier resources ("some/a few/others" and related tail operators).

H3 (Indefinite Tail Activation, ITA). When FIRST anchors the beginning of a sequence, the remaining successor slots are introduced as an underspecified remainder variable $R = \text{TAIL}(\min)$. R is lexically realizable either by non-specific indefinites (some, a few, several, many) or by specific tail-closure operators (all, each, every) depending on discourse goals.

H4 (RED/DED bidirectionality over the head-tail family). RED implements refinement paths from cardinal to ordinal to tail activation (discretization into addressable successors); DED implements inverse coarsening that collapses refined successor structure back into head-level quantificational summaries. The hypothesis predicts systematic diagnostics for refinement vs coarsening, including continuation licensing and failure of implicature-style cancellation tests.

The new step developed here is to integrate this remainder-indefinite effect into a broader quantifier typology. The core claim is an ordinal→remainder-indefinite bridge: the definite

“head” domain (cardinals and their ordinal/positional derivatives) entails a “tail” domain of indefinite quantification. This bridge yields a structured path: cardinal creates ordinal (coarsening into a positional quantifier), ordinal activates successor tail, and the tail is realized as indefinite quantifiers—either specific-referenced (all/each/every/whole) or non-specific-referenced (some/a few/several/many/most)—depending on which tail-operator is selected in context. (Barwise & Cooper 1981; Keenan & Stavi 1986; Partee 1987; Heim 1982; Kamp & Reyle 1993; Yee 2010).

Methodologically, the proposal does not aim to preserve standard implicature diagnostics. If successor availability and tail-indefiniteness are lexical definedness/interface effects, cancellability and weakening under embedding are not expected to behave like implicatures. The theory is therefore evaluated by its operator-driven predictions and by the stability of its RED/DED diagnostics across constructions. (Beaver 2001; Heim 1982).

Box 1. New hypotheses (SCSL+ITA as head–tail lexical architecture)

H1 (Successor-saturated lexical definedness). FIRST is defined only relative to a successor-bearing sequence Σ ; under successor saturation it activates the entire tail Tail(min).

H2 (Ordinal head $\Rightarrow$ tail availability). Interpreting an ordinal head introduces a remainder domain R that corresponds to the successor tail; tail availability is a lexical/interface consequence, not pragmatic enrichment.

H3 (Indefinite Tail Activation). The remainder variable R must be discharged by a tail-operator, canonically lexicalized as non-specific indefinites (some/a few/others) or as specific closures (each/all/every).

H4 (RED/DED as traversal). RED refines head material (cardinal $\rightarrow$ ordinal anchoring); DED collapses/repackages tail material (ordinal anchoring $\rightarrow$ remainder quantification) and can feed back into cardinal-level coarsening.

2. Related Work and Positioning

The proposal intersects three traditions: ordinal semantics (including analyses relating ordinals to ordering structure and superlative-like mechanisms), generalized quantifier theory and indefinite semantics, and dynamic/discourse frameworks that model anaphora and continuation licensing. Generalized-quantifier accounts provide a typology of quantificational force (Barwise & Cooper 1981; Keenan & Stavi 1986) but do not, by themselves, predict that encountering FIRST must introduce a successor chain or a remainder discourse object. Dynamic approaches (e.g., DRT) can represent a sequence if independently introduced (Heim 1982; Kamp & Reyle 1993), and have been used to model ordinal-related discourse structure (Yee 2010), but they do not force the successor chain and remainder variable to be introduced as a lexical consequence of FIRST. The distinguishing content of the present account is therefore the successor-saturation + ITA package and, additionally, the Head–Tail Quantifier Architecture (HTQA) that links ordinal heads to indefinite tails as a lexical interface mapping rather than as discourse optionality.

The paper’s novelty is theoretical and technical: it introduces a successor-saturated lexical entry for FIRST plus an Indefinite Tail Activation update, develops the ordinal $\rightarrow$ remainder-indefinite bridge as a composed head–tail mapping, derives new non-implicature predictions for

continuation and cancellation, and provides a falsifiable, replication-ready diagnostic protocol; it does not claim new empirical findings.

3. Head–Tail Quantifier Architecture

3.1 The head domain: definite quantifiers and ordinal types

I treat cardinals as determinate quantifiers that denote exact counts (“how many?”) and are stable under article insertion (two vs the two both preserve cardinality). Ordinals are derived positional quantifiers, and I distinguish two classes. Determinate positional ordinals are numerically anchored (first, second, third, n-th) and presuppose a minimum domain size (the third presupposes at least three items). Indeterminate positional ordinals are relational (last, next, previous, the other(s), the rest) and are defined relative to anchors and/or boundaries rather than to a fixed numeric index. (Ionin & Matushansky 2006).

Table 1. Ordinal typology used in the head domain.

Class	Examples	Definedness / presupposition	Formal sketch (informal)
Determinate positional	first, second, third, n-th	Requires $ D \geq n$; uniqueness given total order	$\text{nth}(D, n) = \text{the unique element at position } n$
Indeterminate positional	last, next, previous, the others, the rest	Requires boundary or anchor; may return set (others/rest)	$\text{last}(D) = \max(D)$; $\text{next}(x, D) = \text{succ}(x)$; $\text{others}(D, x) = D \setminus \{x\}$

3.2 The tail domain: indefinite quantifiers as remainder operators

Indefinite quantifiers are treated as tail operators that quantify over an already introduced domain. I adopt a two-way split aligned with referential specificity. Specific-referenced indefinites (all, each, every, both, either, neither, the rest, the remainder, the whole) require a contextually fixed domain and typically pick out a determinate subset or choice. Non-specific-referenced indefinites (some, a few, several, many, most, much, little) presuppose a domain but do not determine a specific quantity, leaving the remainder underspecified. (Barwise & Cooper 1981; Keenan & Stavi 1986; Partee 1987; Heim 1982; Yee 2010).

A non-standard component of HTQA concerns **all**. Standard generalized-quantifier semantics treats **all** as a universal quantifier over a domain. In the present architecture, **all** is reinterpreted as a closure operator on a successor tail: it does not itself encode a numeric bound; rather, it signals closure over an already given tail domain, which can expand with contextual domain shifts (“all the books on the table / in the room / in the city”). This shift is a deliberate theoretical commitment and yields diagnostic consequences in continuation and domain accommodation. (Barwise & Cooper 1981; Keenan & Stavi 1986).

Box 3. ALL as a tail-closure operator (not $\forall$)

Definition (TAIL-CLOSE). Let R be the remainder variable introduced by ITA. ALL is an operator that closes R: $ALL(R) = CLOSE(R)$, returning a maximally closed tail set relative to Σ . $ALL(R)$ does not encode an intrinsic number; it discharges remainder availability by closure rather than by cardinality.

Divergence prediction. Standard universal $\forall$ predicts truth-conditional invariance under tail re-partitioning; TAIL-CLOSE predicts sensitivity to sequence closure and to repair under underspecified domain restrictions (e.g., “all the others” vs “each of the others”).

3.3 The bridge: ordinal head entails an indefinite tail

The ordinal→remainder-indefinite bridge states: once an ordinal head is interpreted in a successor-closed sequence, the successor tail is introduced as a discourse-relevant remainder. HTQA treats this remainder as a family-slot resource that can be lexicalized by indefinite quantifiers. The head is therefore not merely a selector of one position; it is an introduction of a structured tail domain that supports both specific and non-specific indefinite quantification. (Heim 1982; Kamp & Reyle 1993). This yields a compositional path: (i) a cardinal (n) supplies a coarse count; (ii) ordinalization maps the count to a positional quantifier (n-th), yielding a refined, addressable structure; (iii) Indefinite Tail Activation introduces the remainder as a tail variable R; and (iv) tail operators (some, a few, all, each, etc.) quantify over R, optionally feeding back to the head by coercing additional positional commitments. (Ionin & Matushansky 2006).

Table 4. Head–tail interaction typology predicted by HTQA + ITA.

Ordinal type (head)	Tail operator: $\exists$ some/a few	Tail operator: distributive each	Tail operator: closure all	Entailment profile (successor/tail)
Determinate positional (1st/2nd/3rd; numerical derivative)	Licensed; introduces non-specific remainder subset of Tail(min)	Licensed; distributes over Tail(min) (strong tail commitment)	Licensed; discharges R by closure (maximal tail commitment)	Strong successor presupposition; tail introduced by ITA; operator determines strength/closure
Indeterminate positional (last/final/other/in-between)	Variable; may target complement-of-head or interval remainder	Selective; depends on interval/partition semantics	Often forces closure over a contextually defined interval tail	Successor structure may be interval-anchored; tail availability persists but partitions differ

3.4 ULD-geometry interpretation: a quantitative slot-family

In ULD-geometry terms, HTQA can be read as a slot-family organization at the quantitative lexical level. The head domain corresponds to more determinate quantifier slots (exact cardinals and determinate positional operators), while the tail domain corresponds to less determinate slots that distribute remainder structure across discourse (indefinites). The successor-saturated ordinal acts as a family-slot trigger: it introduces a structured remainder and thereby makes available a graded inventory of tail lexicalizations, ranging from more determinate tail closures (all/each/every, the remainder, the rest) to less determinate tail introductions (some/a few/several).

Box 5. ULD quantitative slot-family mapping (Head generates Tail)

Mapping. At the quantitative lexical level, the Universal Noun Slot family splits into a Head family (determinate quantifiers: cardinals/ordinals) and a Tail family (indefinite resources: specific-referential and non-specific-referential).

Generation claim. Head activation generates Tail availability: interpreting an ordinal head in the Head family introduces a Tail remainder variable R distributed over Tail slots (more determinate: each/all; less determinate: some/a few).

Falsifier. If an ordinal head is interpreted in a context with a well-formed successor structure but systematically fails to license any remainder-indefinite continuation (relative to matched controls), then Head→Tail generation (as a slot-family consequence) is false.

On this view, the “universal noun slot” corresponds to a general capacity to package quantitative structure as discrete, discussable objects. Ordinalization is the head-side packaging step (cardinal→ordinal), and ITA is the tail-side packaging step that turns the successor tail into a countable discourse object that can be quantified over by indefinites. RED/DED are then the measurable traversals across this slot-family: RED moves downstream to finer positions; DED moves upstream to coarser remainder quantification.

4. Formal Account

4.1 Successor-closed sequences

Let a sequence be an index structure $\Sigma = \langle I, <, \text{succ}, \text{min} \rangle$ where I is a non-empty set of indices, $<$ is a strict order, min returns the initial index, and succ is a (partial) successor function. Under SCSL, FIRST is defined only if $\text{succ}(\text{min}(I))$ is defined; minimally, this requires $|I| \geq 2$.

Successor saturation strengthens this by requiring the active segment to be successor-closed: for each i in the active segment (except a final boundary, if any), $\text{succ}(i)$ is defined and reachable by iteration from $\text{min}(I)$.

4.2 Lexical entry for FIRST with successor saturation

I model FIRST as a partial function that returns the minimal element and triggers a definedness condition on succ . Informally: $\text{FIRST}(D)$ is defined only if D is ordered, non-empty, and $\text{succ}(\text{min}(D))$ is defined; when defined it returns $\text{min}(D)$. Under successor saturation, the lexical interface additionally makes the successor tail $\text{Tail}(\text{min}(D)) = \{ j \text{ in } D : \text{min}(D) < j \}$ available for subsequent operations. (Beaver 2001; Heim 1982).

4.3 Indefinite Tail Activation as an interface update

ITA is modeled as a discourse update triggered by FIRST: interpreting FIRST introduces a remainder variable R whose value is $\text{Tail}(\text{min}(D))$ (or the successor-closed tail segment under contextual restriction). The default lexicalization of R is non-specific indefiniteness (“some others”), but R can be bound or closed by specific tail operators (“all the others”, “each of the others”), producing distinct continuation signatures. (Heim 1982; Kamp & Reyle 1993; Yee 2010).

4.4 From FIRST to SECOND and beyond

The $\text{FIRST} \Rightarrow \text{SECOND}$ entailment is computed by succ: if FIRST is defined, $\text{succ}(\min(D))$ exists, and SECOND can be defined as $\text{succ}(\text{FIRST}(D))$. More strongly, successor saturation makes the entire chain available: $\text{SECOND} \Rightarrow \text{THIRD}$ follows by iterating succ, and the remainder variable R makes these indices addressable even when they are not explicitly named. This provides the formal basis for “FIRST activates the entire successor tail.” (Beaver 2001).

Box 2. Lexical Tail Theorem (LTT)

If an ordinal head ORD_1 (e.g., FIRST) is interpreted relative to a sequence structure Σ , then interpretation is defined only if Σ contains a non-empty successor tail.

The semantic interface introduces a remainder variable $R = \text{Tail}(\text{ORD}_1)$ that must be discharged by a tail-operator ($\exists$ some, distributive each, closure all, etc.) within a bounded discourse window, unless repaired.

Consequence: ITA is mandatory by default; apparent “cancellation” of the tail is predicted to induce definedness failure or metalinguistic repair rather than ordinary implicature cancellation.

5. RED/DED Diagnostic Architecture

5.1 RED/DED as definitional mappings (ordinalization and tail activation)

Definition (Ordinalization as RED output). $\text{RED}(\text{cardinal } n)$ yields an ordinal head ORD_1 that refines a coarse quantity into a structured index anchor: $\text{RED}(n) \rightarrow \text{ORD}_1$. (Ionin & Matushansky 2006).

Commutation claim. $\text{RED then ITA} \neq \text{ITA then RED}$: ordinalization (RED) fixes the head anchor that determines which tail is introduced; tail activation without head anchoring predicts weaker or unstable remainder licensing. This predicts that “some others” is systematically licensed after ordinal anchoring but not after non-ordinal controls.

Definition (Tail activation and coarsening as DED). DED applied to an ordinal head returns (i) cardinal feedback (coarsening back to macro-quantity) and (ii) remainder activation: $\text{DED}(\text{ORD}_1) \rightarrow \langle n', R \rangle$ where $R = \text{Tail}(\text{ORD}_1)$.

RED and DED are treated as paired operators that traverse the head–tail structure bidirectionally. RED (Refinement Entailment Diagnostic) reifies continuous ordering into discrete, countable positions by iterating successor: $\text{FIRST} \rightarrow \text{SECOND} \rightarrow \text{THIRD} \rightarrow \dots$. DED (De-Entailment / Collapse) implements controlled coarsening: it collapses a refined microstructure into a coarse remainder expressed by indefinites ($\text{TAIL} \sim \text{SOME}(\text{others})$, or $\text{TAIL} \sim \text{ALL}(\text{others})$). (Panner 2026b).

Table 2. Operator procedures for refinement and collapse in HTQA.

Operator	Input	Output	Interpretation	Measurable diagnostic
RED	Ordinal head (FIRST) + sequence Σ	Refined position (SECOND, THIRD, ...)	Iterate succ; reify positions	Continuation licensing; anaphora; ellipsis recoverability

DED	Refined chain / tail variable R	Coarse remainder (some/a few/others; all/each/every)	Collapse microstructure into tail quantifier	Cancellability failure; tail continuation naturalness
RED◦ DED	FIRST with successor saturation	FIRST + tail- indefinite remainder	Composed bridge FIRST→TAIL~INDEF	SR vs control minimal pairs; SR–Ctrl deltas

6. Diagnostics and Predictions

6.1 Minimal pairs: ordinal anchoring vs controls

6.3 Non-obvious consequences and competitor stress tests

Box 4. No-Cancellation Proposition (NCP)

In SCSL+ITA, “first ... but there is no second / no others” cannot be a genuine cancellation. It is either (i) definedness failure (LTT violated: Tail(min)= $\emptyset$), or (ii) metalinguistic repair that overrides the ordinal’s lexical interface contribution. Therefore, the degradation is predicted to be categorical (contradiction/repair), not gradient pragmatic weakening.

Competitor contrast (“diagnostics inversion”). A pure implicature account predicts weakening under embedding and cancellability (e.g., ‘first, but maybe no second’ should be repairable as pragmatic cancellation). SCSL+ITA predicts persistence/repair signatures: attempted cancellation yields contradiction-like degradation or metalinguistic repair, not simple weakening. (Grice 1975; Horn 1989; Levinson 2000).

Projection under embedding (defining property). Because LTT and ITA are lexical/interface effects, successor/tail commitments are predicted to project under negation and modals unless explicitly repaired. Under questions and conditionals, ITA behaves like a presuppositional/update requirement rather than like a cancellable implicature. (Beaver 2001; Heim 1982; Kratzer 1991; Karttunen 1974).

The central diagnostic family tests whether explicit ordinal anchoring (“first”) increases the naturalness and recoverability of remainder-indefinite continuations relative to controls that lack successor saturation. A representative English pair is given below. The SCSL+ITA prediction is that (a) should license “some others” with higher continuation naturalness and stronger successor/tail entailments than (b). (Yee 2010).

- (1) a. John was first. Some others followed.
b. John was prominent. Some others followed.

6.2 Prediction table (discriminating signatures)

Table 3. Distinguishing predictions for HTQA + ITA vs baselines.

Prediction	HTQA+ITA	GQ-only baseline	DRT-only baseline	Diagnostic test	Falsifier
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FIRST→tail -indefinite availability	FIRST introduces tail variable R; “some others” licensed without extra setup	No lexical remainder variable; continuation depends on general plausibility	Can represent remainder if introduced, but not forced by FIRST	Continuation naturalness + anaphora recoverability	No SR–Ctrl advantage for “some others” across languages
Cancellability degradation	“first... but no second” yields contradiction/repair, not clean cancellation	Cancellability expected if enrichment is pragmatic	Cancellation depends on discourse accommodation, not lexical definedness	Acceptability of cancellation items vs controls	Cancellation not degraded beyond controls
Specific vs non-specific tail choice	Tail operators map onto R: all/each/every close or distribute over tail; some/a few leave R underspecified	Choice of quantifier does not track ordinal anchoring	Quantifier choice tracks discourse salience, not lexical tail	Quantifier substitution in matched contexts	Tail quantifier distribution unrelated to ordinal anchoring

7. Methods: Replication-Ready Protocol (No New Data)

Design. Within-subject minimal-pair design comparing successor-saturated ordinal (SR) conditions to matched controls (Ctrl) that remove ordinal anchoring while preserving propositional content. Languages: English plus at least one typologically distinct language with ordinal morphology and indefinite strategies (e.g., Turkish).

Sample plan. Consultant judgments: target N=8 for English and N=6 for Turkish (or another non-Germanic language); 12 items total; approximately 10 minutes per participant. Exclusions: failed attention checks, inconsistent scale use or outlier response patterns. Coding: (i) acceptability (1–7), (ii) continuation/retrieval naturalness (1–7), and (iii) entailment-strength codes (0–2) for successor commitment and tail-availability. Planned analysis: compute SR–Ctrl deltas per item family; report means and confidence intervals; optional mixed-effects model if sufficient observations.

8. Computational and Neuroscientific Implications

Computationally, successor saturation predicts that ordinal tokens should activate a structured tail state in incremental parsing and in discourse-state tracking, yielding measurable differences in continuation preferences and in anaphora resolution. In a symbolic implementation, ITA corresponds to introducing a remainder variable R whose type is a set of indices or individuals; in neural/LLM settings, the hypothesis predicts that “first” should increase probability mass for continuations with remainder indefinites (others/some/a few) compared to controls.

Neuroscientifically, the proposal predicts that ordinal processing recruits successor-chain representations and working-memory resources for maintaining a tail set, aligning with accounts that treat discourse update as an incremental memory operation rather than a purely pragmatic inference.

9. Limitations

The present paper does not report new experimental results; it is a theory-and-diagnostics contribution. The strongest predictable objections concern (i) free adjunction or pragmatic bridging as an alternative source of “some others” continuations, (ii) the sensitivity of ellipsis/anaphora diagnostics to register and discourse genre, and (iii) cross-linguistic variation in ordinal morphology and indefinite systems. The protocol and falsifiers are designed to adjudicate these alternatives by comparing SR vs control signatures and by requiring stable cross-language effects.

10. Conclusion

This paper develops an ordinal→remainder-indefinite bridge inside a successor-saturated lexical entry for FIRST. The Head–Tail Quantifier Architecture (HTQA) links cardinal-derived ordinal heads to an induced tail domain of indefinite quantification, implemented as an Indefinite Tail Activation update and diagnosed via a bidirectional RED/DED operator procedure. The contribution is theoretical and technical: it proposes a new lexical hypothesis (SCSL+successor saturation + ITA/HTQA), derives falsifiable predictions that intentionally redesign standard implicature diagnostics, and supplies replication-ready elicitation and coding formats. The next step is to apply the protocol to consultant judgments and/or annotated corpora to test whether successor-saturated ordinals yield the predicted continuation advantage and cancellation degradation across languages. (Panner 2026a; Panner 2026b).

Appendix A. Compact elicitation grid (HTQA/ITA)

Table A1. Compact elicitation grid for head–tail mapping (illustrative English forms; adapt lexemes per language).

Cell	Construction prompt	Target	Control	Diagnosis focus
A1	X was first. ____ followed.	some others / the others / all the others	X was prominent. ____ followed.	ITA remainder licensing
A2	X was first. Not ____ followed.	some others / anyone else	X was prominent. Not ____ followed.	cancellation degradation
A3	X was first of the three. ____ followed.	the second / the rest / all the rest	X was best of the three. ____ followed.	RED refinement vs DED collapse

A4	X was first. Each of the others —.	each/every + remainder	X was prominent. Each of the others —.	specific-referenced tail operators
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Appendix B. Fillable results matrices (templates; no empirical claims)

No empirical claims are made from these values; they illustrate the reporting format only.

Table B1. Acceptability matrix (1–7) for ITA minimal pairs (participants × items).

Item	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6
MP1						

Table B2. Continuation / retrieval naturalness matrix (1–7) (participants × selected items).

Item	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6
MP1						

Table B3. Entailment-strength coding matrix (0–2) for successor and tail commitment.

Item	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6
MP1						

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